

Helen Webley-Brown

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Education

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| Ph.D. in Sociology , Stanford University | Palo Alto, CA |
| • Honors: CCSRE Emerging Scholar | Sept 2025 – Present |
| S.M. in Political Science , Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) | Cambridge, MA |
| • Thesis: Democracy Under Surveillance: The Effect of Pretrial Electronic Monitoring on Voting Behavior | Feb 2025 |
| • Fields: American Politics, Quantitative Methods [GPA: 4.9/5.0] | |
| A.B. in Political Science , Washington University in St. Louis (WashU) | St. Louis, MO |
| • Honors: Danforth Scholar, Civic Scholar, College Honors, Phi Beta Kappa [GPA: 3.97/4.0] | May 2022 |

Publications

- Webley-Brown, H.** and Sukin, L. (2026). [Divisions at Home, Broken Promises Abroad? How Domestic Politics Shapes the United States' Nuclear Credibility](#). International Studies Quarterly.
- Gupta, A., Wu, V., **Webley-Brown, H.**, King, J., and Ho, D. (2023). [The Privacy-Bias Tradeoff: Data Minimization and Racial Disparity Assessments in U.S. Government](#). ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency (FAccT).
- [Best Paper Award](#) at FAccT, 2023
 - [Student Paper Award](#) from Future of Privacy Forum, 2023

Other Writing

- Webley-Brown, H.**, Sipek, A., Buoymaster, K., Shivalkar, J., Owen, W., and Manis, E. (2022). [ShotSpotter and the Misfires of Gunshot Detection Technology](#). Surveillance Technology Oversight Project.
- Loshkajian, N., Van Doran, S., Melendi, J., Saran, S., **Webley-Brown, H.**, and Manis, E. (2022). [Privatizing The Surveillance State: How Police Foundations Undermine Rule of Law](#). Surveillance Technology Oversight Project.

Working Papers

- Global Ideological Polarization In Nuclear Attitudes: Evidence From 23 Countries (with Lauren Sukin)
- How Generative AI Reshapes the Citizen–Government Information Exchange (with Chris Cai, Peter John, and Helen Margetts)
- Citizen–Government Information Exchange In The Age of AI (with Chris Cai, Peter John, and Helen Margetts)

Works in Progress

- Telling on Yourself To Build Trust: The Effect of Open Data Initiatives on Public Perceptions of the Police
- Why Watch The Watchers? Frame Utilization In Community Control Over Police Surveillance (CCOPS) Legislation
- Democracy at Home: How Racial Diversity in Public Housing Developments Shape Resident Council Emergence
- The Face of Public Housing: Measuring Descriptive Representation in Public Housing Authority Leadership

Research Experience

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| Data Consultant , UnCommon Law | Oakland, CA |
| • Clean and analyse original California parole hearing datasets | July 2026 – Present |
| Research Assistant , Oxford Internet Institute (Prof. Helen Margetts) | London, England |
| • Analyzed original survey data on trends in UK citizen-government information exchange | Jan 2025 – Dec 2025 |
| Research Officer , LSE Phelan United States Center (Prof. Lauren Sukin) | London, England |
| • Conducted quantitative and archival data analysis across Dr. Sukin's research portfolio | Dec 2024 – Aug 2025 |

Research Assistant , MIT Political Science (Prof. Ariel White)	Cambridge, MA May 2023 – Aug 2023
Used Sequential Monte Carlo algorithm to analyze impact of prison gerrymandering reforms on legislative outcomes	
Summer Research Fellow , Stanford Regulation, Evaluation, and Governance Lab	Remote June 2022 – Aug 2022
- Conducted content analysis of 25 federal agencies' equity action plans - Analyzed privacy-related barriers to data collection, and its impact on bias assessments	
Research Intern , Surveillance Technology Oversight Project	Remote Jan 2022 – May 2022
- Wrote two reports on emerging surveillance technologies' impact on civil rights - Created data visualization of racial disparities in ShotSpotter technology deployment	
Student Researcher , Modernist Prehistory of Facial Recognition Lab (Prof. Anca Parvulescu)	St. Louis, MO Sept 2021 – Dec 2021
Researched facial recognition's physiognomic roots using archival and literary analysis	
Data Analysis and Research Intern , The Bail Project	St. Louis, MO June 2021 – Aug 2021
- Performed data fidelity checks on Salesforce reports with 900+ unique client records - Surveyed 43 clients and conducted 3 interviews to write report on socio-economic impacts of pretrial electronic monitoring	
Research Assistant , WashU Sociology (Prof. Sarah Gaby)	St. Louis, MO Jan 2020 – June 2020
Analyzed sentiment in pre/post class survey data to track changes in protest attitudes	

Teaching Assistant Experience

Making Public Policy (UG) , MIT Political Science (Prof. Andrea Campbell)	Fall 2024
Quantitative Political Methodology (UG) , WashU Political Science (Prof. Christopher Lucas)	Spring 2021
Social Movements (UG) , WashU Sociology (Prof. Sarah Gaby)	Spring 2020

Pedagogical Training

MIT Teaching + Learning Lab Teaching Certificate	Fall 2024
Course Design Track (backward design, inclusive class policies, syllabus development) Lesson Planning Track (giving formative feedback, active learning) Inclusive Teaching Track (strategies to foster a welcoming, equitable classroom) Microteaching Track (lecture skills, facilitating discussions, teaching demos)	

Service

First-Year Representative , Association of Sociology Graduate Students, Stanford Sociology	Fall 2025 – Spring 2026
Co-Chair , Graduate Student Works-in-Progress Workshop, MIT Political Science	Fall 2023 – Spring 2024
Diversity Co-Chair , Graduate Student Council, MIT Political Science	Fall 2023 – Spring 2024
Mentor , Political Science Application Mentorship Program (PSAMP), MIT Political Science	Fall 2022

Conferences and Workshops

The Domestic Foundations of Nuclear Policy , Nuffield College (Oxford, UK)	2026
American Politics Group (APG) Early Career Researcher Conference , LSE (London, UK)	2025
BRIDGE Event on Electronic Monitoring , Arnold Ventures (Washington DC, USA)	2025
Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA) , (Chicago, IL, USA)	2024

Grants and Awards

Stanford , CCSRE Emerging Scholars Award (3-year fellowship)	2025
MIT , Political Methodology Lab Research Grant (\$1000)	2023
Future of Privacy Forum , Student Paper Award (shared with co-authors)	2023

FAccT , Best Paper Award (shared with co-authors)	2023
WashU , Shepley Outstanding Senior Award	2022
WashU , Harriet K. Switzer Leadership Award	2022
WashU , Gephardt Institute Fox-Clark Civic Scholarship	2020
WashU , William H. Danforth Scholarship (4-year full tuition award)	2018

Non-Academic Experience

Legal Lark , Founder and Project Manager	St. Louis, MO
- Managed team of 4 to create website on e-carceration and juvenile justice - Built resource bank, designed infographics, and wrote articles on youth incarceration	May 2021 – May 2022
Government Affairs Intern , Human Rights Campaign	Remote
- Coded 506 cities’ LGBTQ+ police liaison policies for HRC’s Municipal Equality Index - Tracked politicians’ votes and bill sponsorships for HRC’s Congressional Scorecard	Jan 2021 – April 2021
Public Affairs and Communications Intern , Hanbury Strategy	London, England
Drafted client op-eds, government consultation responses, and stakeholder maps	June 2020 – Sept 2020
Campaign Donations Researcher , Lavender for State Senate	Remote
Researched past contributions of 300+ potential donors; out-raised incumbent by 106%	June 2020 – Aug 2020

Technical Skills

T_EX, R and R Studio, Python, ArcGIS, QGIS